

EC571 Fall 2026
Setting up SCC OnDemand Desktop

Acknowledgement

The following individuals have contributed to developing this mini tutorial: Alperen Yasar, Saraja Kadambari, Laith Shameih, Timur Zirtiloglu, Ajay Joshi, and Rabia Yazicigil.

Note:

SCC uses different storage than the machines in PHO305. To access your files, use the path below:
/ad/eng/users/<First letter of your user ID>/<Second Letter of your user ID>/<BU ID>/

Connecting to SCC servers

We will run the Cadence Virtuoso tool on the SCC servers for designing digital VLSI circuits. See the instructions below for connecting to SCC servers and setting up your SCC OnDemand Desktop.

1. The easiest way to connect to SCC Servers is using SCC OnDemand services, which help you open SCC in your Web Browser.
2. To access SCC OnDemand, go to <https://scc-ondemand1.bu.edu> and log in using your BU login name and Kerberos password.
3. After logging in, go to Interactive Apps → Desktop (see Figure 1).

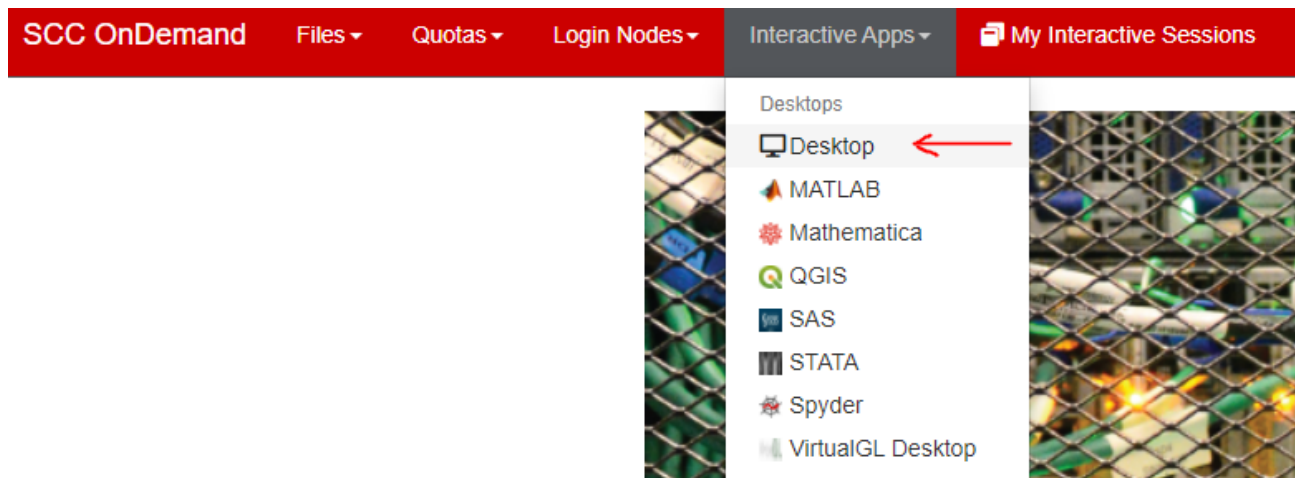


Figure 1

4. You should configure your desktop as shown below. Make sure to set “Project” as ec571 (see Figure 2). The “number of hours” means how long you will open this SCC view, and “number of cores” is the number of cores your SCC session will use. We suggest using 12 for the number of hours and 1 for the number of cores. Your SCC session will be closed after 12 hours. Any unsaved data will be lost. If you expect to use the session for more than 12 hours, then choose the number of hours accordingly. Click “Launch” when you configure the form.

Desktop

This app will launch an interactive desktop on a compute node.

List of modules to load (space separated)

Select Modules

Working Directory

Select Directory

The directory to start in. (Defaults to home directory.)

Initial command to run

Number of hours

Number of cores

Number of gpus

Project

▼

Extra qsub options

☐ I would like to receive an email when the session starts

Launch

* The Desktop session data for this session can be accessed under the data root directory.

Figure 2

5. After the form is submitted, a session will be created for you. When the session is created, you will see the desktop information on your screen. See screenshot in Figure 3.

Desktop (55812)

1 core | Running

Host: >_scc-wid

Delete

Created at: 2021-01-28 08:51:10 EST

Time Remaining: 5 hours and 59 minutes

Session ID: a240449d-9c99-434d-91d1-98142f779831

Compression

0 (low) to 9 (high)

Connect to Desktop

Image Quality

0 (low) to 9 (high)

View Only (Share-able Link)

Figure 3

6. Click on the “Connect to Desktop” button. You are now running a desktop on the SCC servers.